

Ramamurthy, who met 300-350 brokers as part of this exercise to understand the bottlenecks that were stifling BSE's growth.

What emerged was interesting. A large section of retail brokers had not even enabled BSE on their mobile trading platforms and even those that had, did not create a level playing field between BSE and NSE in terms of features and accessibility on the platform.

"The important ingredient is the voice of the customer," says the BSE boss while highlighting the feedback that he got from the market, which ultimately led him to take the first set of steps to ensure that there was some amount of traction in the cash and F&O segments of the exchange.

To start with, BSE reduced the so-called tick size—the minimum difference in the bid and offer price—of nearly 650 stocks; that saw its market share go up in those



"NSE and BSE are not competing as all the companies are listed on both the exchanges, the same set of regulations apply to both and even the brokers and investors are the same on both"

ASHISHKUMAR CHAUHAN

MD & CEO, NSE, IN AN EARLIER INTERACTION WITH BT

stocks from less than 10% earlier to around 12% in the past few months.

Then it was time to address the elephant in the room—how to revive BSE's F&O segment. This assumes significance as there have been various attempts in the past—even market-making schemes were launched where brokers were paid to trade—to revive BSE's derivatives segment, but they all met with failure.

This time, though, the market feedback was taken into account and tweaks were announced. For instance, derivatives on Sensex 30 and Bankex indices were re-launched while ensuring that the expiries did not clash with those of the more-popular instruments of NSE. The relaunch happened in May last year and since then there has been a gradual and consistent rise in BSE's market share.

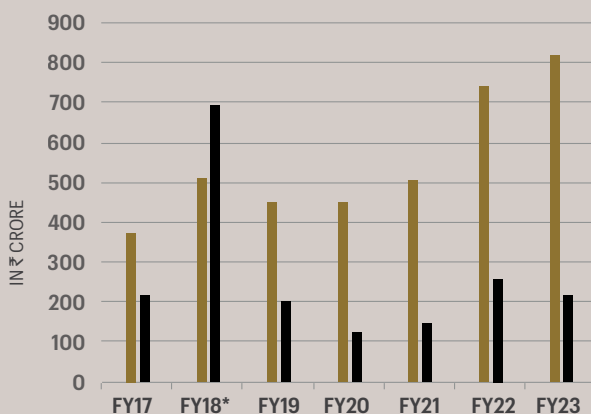
Interestingly, the collateral benefits include the co-location

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STRENGTH IN NUMBERS

► BSE's income has more than doubled in the past six years

► The cash/bank balance has also been steady in the past two years, up from FY21



● INCOME ● PAT; *HIGHER PAT DUE TO STAKE SALE IN CDSL

SOURCE ACE EQUITY



● CASH/BANK BALANCE

SOURCE ACE EQUITY